Grade 12 Business Studies
Paper 1 Marking Guideline

150 marks available · Award only the marks shown. Accept other relevant, correctly explained answers. Avoid double-credit for repeated points.

Draft memo requires educator moderation and subject-specialist review before use.

SECTION A · ANSWER KEY (30 marks)

Item	Answer	Reason
1	B · Macro	One correct option; 2 marks.
2	A · a controllable capability	One correct option; 2 marks.
3	D · Fix a recorded variance	One correct option; 2 marks.
4	A · procurement	One correct option; 2 marks.
5	A · orient a new employee	One correct option; 2 marks.
6	B · early enough to inform the decision	One correct option; 2 marks.
7	A · consumer rights	One correct option; 2 marks.
8	A · observable and measurable	One correct option; 2 marks.
9	A · its members	One correct option; 2 marks.
10	A · total revenue equals total cost	One correct option; 2 marks.
11	A · market and operating assumptions	One correct option; 2 marks.
12	A · intellectual-property rights	One correct option; 2 marks.
13	A · inform decisions about customers	One correct option; 2 marks.

14	A · private interests may bias a duty	One correct option; 2 marks.
15	A · economic, social and environmental effects	One correct option; 2 marks.

SECTION B · MARKING GUIDELINES (80 counted)

Each question totals 40. Mark all three questions if attempted; retain the best two complete question scores, subject to school policy.

Question 1: Case study — Khula Kitchens (40 marks)

Part	Expected evidence and allocation	Marks
1.1	2 marks: municipal by-law = macro / external legal-political environment; 2 marks: late-order issue = internal operations (accept micro only if linked to controllable workflow). Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	4
1.2	Award up to 4 linked pairs: compliance cost/capital for grease traps; inspection time or temporary disruption; changed process and record keeping; customer confidence if compliant. One mark for each relevant effect and one for its explanation/application. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	8
1.3	Up to 4 marks per response: select order tracking/capacity scheduling or customer recovery/communication; explain how it reduces delay or repairs trust. Credit other feasible responses tied to the complaint. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	8
1.4	Up to 8: employee voice reveals shift constraints; early consultation builds buy-in; identifies lawful/fair options; reduces conflict and implementation risk. Award a relevant point and its explanation for each strand; consultation does not replace legal duties. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	8
1.5	Up to 12: demand/capacity evidence; capital and working-capital affordability given tight cash flow; supplier and staffing readiness; staged pilot/lease alternative; risk of delay versus growth benefit; explicit justified recommendation. Up to 2 marks per developed consideration. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	12

Question 2: Applied business environments (40 marks)

Part	Expected evidence and allocation	Marks
2.1	2 marks: threat is an external condition with adverse effect; 2 marks: opportunity is an external condition with potential benefit. Internal strengths/weaknesses are not threats/opportunities. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	4
2.2	Award 1 mark for each force correctly identified and 1 for explaining its effect: rivalry, new entrants, substitutes, buyer power, supplier power. Up to 8; market application strengthens the explanation. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	8
2.3	Any four distinct links (2 each): fair recruitment/equal opportunity; lawful employment terms/hours; employee relations/collective processes; workplace health and safety; privacy/data handling. Name a relevant duty and show its HR consequence. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	8
2.4	Up to 5 per pressure: online competitor response (differentiate, improve digital convenience, retain customers, or focused pricing) and transport cost response (consolidate deliveries, review sourcing/location, load-plan or transparent pricing); explain effect and trade-off for each. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	10
2.5	Benefits: scans political, economic, social, technological, legal and environmental context; structures assumptions; spots external change. Limits: broad/static, data quality, uncertain timing, cannot replace competitor/customer/financial analysis. Award balanced evaluation and justified use. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	10

Question 3: Applied business operations (40 marks)

Part	Expected evidence and allocation	Marks
3.1	Plan a standard; do the process; check results against the standard; act to correct and improve. One mark each in a coherent cycle. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	4
3.2	Up to 4 paired explanations: induction clarifies role/rules/process; skills development builds competence; fewer errors/waste; confidence/safety/service improves. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	8

3.3	Any four, 2 marks each when explained: total cost; quality/specification; reliability/lead time; capacity/continuity; compliance/ethical sourcing; location/logistics; support/payment terms. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	8
3.4	Up to 10: define output/quality standard; measure by shift using consistent records; compare actual to target; identify causes (staffing, equipment, inputs); agree corrective action; train/support; assign owner/date; remeasure and document. Award feasible measurable steps. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	10
3.5	Up to 10 balanced application: productivity through workflow and standards; wellbeing through safe staffing, breaks and voice; customer service through reliable quality and clear recovery; monitor trade-offs with measures; recommend a practical balance. Credit precise use of case evidence where requested; do not award unsupported assertions.	10

SECTION C · ESSAY GUIDELINE (40 marks)

Use the common rubric printed on the question paper: framing 4; accurate knowledge 12; analysis/application 12; evaluation/synthesis 8; structure and conclusion 4. Award proportionately for relevant, developed content; accept different defensible positions. A list without explanation cannot receive analysis or evaluation marks.

CAPS alignment and moderation note

Paper 1 addresses the Grade 12 topic pair: Business Environments and Business Operations. The arrangement follows the DBE Business Studies examination guideline structure (Section A 30; Section B select two of three 40-mark questions; Section C select one of two 40-mark essays; 150 marks, 120 minutes). This is a newly authored practice draft; it is not an official DBE paper. CAPS source SHA-256: e6f0a21b96fa87ccfccb732a9240a579bf0157916b86a1cdd98a2876cf76db27. Before classroom use, an educator must validate topic coverage, the item-level mark scheme, accessibility and current examination policy.